

Does HSV shorten your lifespan?

Becoming infected with **the herpes virus** seriously complicates your social, emotional and sexual life, but it is not otherwise a terribly dangerous condition to have. Having **genital herpes does** make it easier to get HIV (and thus AIDS), but otherwise, the condition is not disabling, and does not reduce lifespan.

person appears to be widely distributed and transmitted through saliva.

In 1994, DNA sequences presumed to represent a new herpes virus from **tissues of Kaposi's sarcoma** from AIDS patients named as HHV8. Later identified in Kaposi's sarcoma in persons not infected with HIV and referred to as **Kaposi's Sarcoma-associated herpes virus** (KSHV).

10.4 Hepatitis Viruses

The term viral hepatitis refers to a **primary infection of the liver**, hepatitis viruses consists of types A, B, C, D, E and G. Except for **type B** which is a DNA virus all the others are RNA viruses.

Two types of viral hepatitis had been recognised **type one** affects mainly children and young adults and transmitted by the fecal-oral route called **as infective or infectious hepatitits or type A hepatitis. Second type** transmitted mainly by receiving serum inoculation or blood transfusion named as **homologous serum jaundice, serum hepatitis transfusion hepatitis or type B hepatitis**.

Type A Hepatitis (HAV)

HAV is a 27nm non enveloped RNA virus belonging to the **picorna virus family**. It is designated as **'entero virus 72'**, HAV is recognised as new genus **'Hepatovirus'**. It can be grown in human and simian cell cultures and is the only human hepatitis virus can be cultivated in vitro.

HAV transmission is by the **fecal oral route**. Infection is by ingestion. The virus multiplies in the intestinal epithelium and reaches the liver by **hematogenous spread**. Once jaundice develops, it is rarely detectable in feces. The incubation period is 2- 6 weeks. The clinical disease consists of two stages the **prodromal and the icteric stage**. The onset may be acute with fever, malaise, anorexia, nausea, vomiting and liver tenderness. These usually subside with the onset of jaundice. Recovery is slow, over a period of **4–6 weeks**. The disease is milder in children. Type A hepatitis caused by **contaminated food, water or milk**. Over crowding and poor sanitation favour its spread.

Laboratory Diagnosis

Diagnosis of type A hepatitis may be made by **demonstration of the virus** or its **antibody**. Virus can be visualized by **Immunelectron Microscopy (IEM)** in fecal extracts during the late incubation period.

IgM anti-HAV antibody appears during the late incubation period disappears after 3-4 months. **IgG** appears peaks in 3-4 months and persists much longer for life. ELISA kits for detection of IgM and IgG antibodies are available.

TN_GOVT_XII_Micro_Biology_CH10.indd 215 04-03-2019 12:27:07